possible. There are certain aspects (such as error handling and authentication) that are made easier by keeping them separate. Of course, running two separate applications has its own difficulties!

You can add a web API controller to your project by creating a new .cs file anywhere in your project. Traditionally, this file is placed in a folder called Controllers, but that's not a technical requirement.

TIP *Vertical slice* architecture and feature folders are (fortunately) becoming more popular in .NET circles. With these approaches, you organize your project based on features instead of technical concepts like controllers and models.

Listing 20.2 shows an example of a simple controller, with a single endpoint, that returns an `IEnumerable<string>` when executed. This example highlights the similarity with traditional MVC controllers (using action methods and a base class) and minimal APIs (returning the response object directly to be serialized later).

Listing 20.2 A simple web API controller

```
[ApiController]                                          ❶
public class FruitController : ControllerBase           ❷
{
    List<string> _fruit = new List<string>               ❸
    {                                                    ❸
        "Pear",                                          ❸
        "Lemon",                                         ❸
        "Peach"                                          ❸
    };                                                   ❸
    [HttpGet("fruit")]                                   ❹
    public IEnumerable<string> Index()                   ❺
    {                                                    ❻
        return _fruit;                                   ❻
    }                                                    ❻
}
```